

MANITHAM LAW FOUNDATION

# Complete Site User Guide

Advocate office portal — how to access and use every module

Primary practice: Gobichettipalayam / Nambiyur region, Erode District, Tamil Nadu (also Karnataka matters as applicable).

One complete document for office staff, advocates, accountants, and administrators.

Updated: 29 July 2026

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## 1. What this portal is

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MLF (Manitham Law Foundation) is the firm's internal office portal. Use it to manage clients, cases, hearings, appointments, cash payments, postal dak, work allotment, HR attendance/leave, reports, employees, and permissions — in one place.

You open the site in a web browser (desktop recommended). You sign in with your Indian mobile number and a 6-digit PIN. What you see in the left menu depends on your role and permissions. Important actions are logged in Activity.

- This guide is for using the live site (not a developer/setup manual).
- If a menu item is missing, you lack permission or the module is off — ask Admin.

## 2. How to access the site

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### 2.1 Open the portal

**Step 1:** Open the portal URL provided by your office.

**Step 2:** If you are not logged in, you are taken to the Login page.

**Step 3:** After a successful login you land on Home.

### 2.2 First-time setup (new user / no PIN yet)

**Step 1:** Enter your 10-digit Indian mobile number (must start with 6–9).

**Step 2:** Continue — the system detects that you need PIN setup.

**Step 3:** Request OTP. An SMS OTP is sent to your mobile.

**Step 4:** Enter the OTP and verify.

**Step 5:** Create a 6-digit PIN and confirm it. Avoid weak PINs (000000, 123456, repeated digits).

**Step 6:** You are signed in and redirected to Home.

### 2.3 Returning user (daily login)

**Step 1:** Enter your 10-digit mobile number.

**Step 2:** Enter your 6-digit PIN.

**Step 3:** Submit — a secure session is set and you go to Home.

### 2.4 Forgot PIN

**Step 1:** On the PIN screen, choose Forgot PIN.

**Step 2:** Request OTP !' enter OTP from SMS !' verify.

**Step 3:** Set a new 6-digit PIN (confirm it).

**Step 4:** You are signed in with the new PIN.

### 2.5 PIN lockout, logout, session expiry

Too many wrong PIN attempts locks the PIN temporarily. Wait for the countdown, or use Forgot PIN.

Logout: open the user menu in the header !' Logout. Cookies are cleared; you return to Login.

If your session expires while working, the app clears cookies and sends you back to Login. Sign in again with mobile + PIN.

## 3. Roles & what each person can do

Access is role-based. Admin has full control. Other roles get a default permission set (Admin can adjust on the Permissions page).

| Role       | Meant for                 | Typical access                                        |
|------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Admin      | Firm owner / full control | Everything — cannot be restricted                     |
| Sub admin  | Office / HR manager       | Ops: clients, cases, HRMS approve, employees, reports |
| Staff      | Clerks, PA, reception     | Clients, cases, appointments, dak, tasks              |
| Advocate   | Counsel / advocates       | Clients, cases, appointments, dak, tasks              |
| Accountant | Accounts team             | Accounts cash book, view clients/cases, reports       |

- Everyone gets: Home view, HRMS view + own attendance + own leave, Notifications, Profile.
- Permission actions: View, Create, Edit, Upload/import, Deactivate, Cancel, Own attendance, Own leave, Team attendance, Approve leave.

## 4. Screen layout & navigation

Left sidebar — modules grouped as Workspace, Matters, Schedule, Office, Admin.

Header — global search (# K / Ctrl+K), notification bell, user menu.

Main content — lists, filters, forms, and detail panels for the selected module.

| Group     | Menu label | Opens             |
|-----------|------------|-------------------|
| Workspace | Home       | Dashboard summary |
| Matters   | Clients    | Client registry   |

|          |                |                                           |
|----------|----------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Matters  | Cases          | Case pipeline & hearings                  |
| Matters  | Day board      | Day view: hearings + appointments + tasks |
| Schedule | Appointments   | Consultations / bookings                  |
| Schedule | Availability   | Advocate hours & blocks                   |
| Office   | Accounts       | Cash payments / fees                      |
| Office   | HRMS           | Attendance, leave, holidays               |
| Office   | Postal         | In/out dak register                       |
| Office   | Work allotment | Office tasks                              |
| Office   | Reports        | Excel exports                             |
| Admin    | Employees      | Staff & advocate users                    |
| Admin    | Activity       | Audit log                                 |
| Admin    | Permissions    | Role permission matrix                    |

- Notifications — header bell !' full inbox (not always in main nav).
- Profile — user menu !' your details / photo; office address PDF may be linked here.
- Documents — inside Case / Client screens (no separate Documents menu).

## 5. Home dashboard & global search

**Step 1:** After login, open Home (or click Home in the sidebar).

**Step 2:** Review summary cards / today's focus (hearings, appointments, tasks as permitted).

**Step 3:** Press # K (Mac) or Ctrl+K (Windows) for global search.

**Step 4:** Type a client name, case id, mobile fragment, etc., then select a result to jump there.

## 6. Clients

Clients is the party registry. Most cases and payments link to a client (IDs like CLI-00001).

Required intake: name + mobile. Recommended: father/spouse, address, city, district, state, matter brief. SMS consent may be collected for hearing reminders.

**Step 1:** Open Clients from Matters !' search / open a row.

**Step 2:** Create: enter name, 10-digit mobile, other fields !' Save (needs clients.create). A CLI-... id is generated.

**Step 3:** Edit existing clients as needed (clients.edit).

**Step 4:** Bulk import via CSV — see Section 15 (recommended first when migrating data).

## 7. Cases, hearings & documents

Cases track matters from enquiry through disposal. Each case links to a client and may have advocates, hearings, documents, and fee payments. Case IDs look like CSE-00001.

| Status        | Meaning                           |
|---------------|-----------------------------------|
| Enquiry       | Consultation / early enquiry      |
| Engaged       | Client engaged the firm           |
| Pre-filing    | Draft / preparation before filing |
| Under filing  | Being filed                       |
| Filing defect | Returned with defect              |
| Active        | Numbered / active matter          |
| Reserved      | Judgment reserved                 |
| Disposed      | Disposed                          |
| Withdrawn     | Withdrawn                         |
| Transferred   | Transferred                       |
| Archived      | Archived                          |

## 7.1 Create & manage a case

**Step 1:** Open Cases !' Create (cases.create).

**Step 2:** Select the client (must exist first).

**Step 3:** Fill opposing party, court, status, advocates (optional), and other matter fields !' Save.

**Step 4:** Open case detail to review client, pipeline, hearings, documents, and fee snippet.

**Step 5:** Update status when the matter moves (cases.edit). Invalid jumps are blocked.

**Step 6:** Complete filing checklist items if shown.

## 7.2 Hearings

**Step 1:** On case detail, add a hearing (date/time, notes as required).

**Step 2:** Saving updates the case next-hearing date; notifications may be sent.

**Step 3:** Adjourn creates a replacement hearing.

**Step 4:** Bulk hearings can be imported via CSV (Section 15).

**Step 5:** A scheduled job can SMS clients about tomorrow's hearings; Day board may also offer notify tools.

## 7.3 Documents

**Step 1:** Open the Documents panel on the case (or client) screen.

**Step 2:** Upload allowed files: PDF, JPEG, PNG, WebP — max 10 MB each.

**Step 3:** Download later from the same panel (permission follows case/accounts rules by document type).

# 8. Day board (diary)

Day board shows one IST calendar day: hearings + appointments + tasks together. You can open it if you have view access to Cases, Appointments, or Tasks.

**Step 1:** Open Day board from Matters.

**Step 2:** Pick the date (defaults to today).

**Step 3:** Review sections: court hearings, appointments, allotted work.

**Step 4:** Click an item to open its full record.

**Step 5:** Use notify / hearing SMS actions if available and permitted.

## 9. Appointments & advocate availability

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### 9.1 Appointments

**Step 1:** Open Appointments under Schedule.

**Step 2:** Create: client/contact, advocate, date-time, purpose (IDs like APT-00001).

**Step 3:** Edit or cancel as needed (cancel needs appointments.cancel).

**Step 4:** Convert to enquiry case when the consultation becomes a matter.

### 9.2 Availability

**Step 1:** Open Availability under Schedule.

**Step 2:** Set advocate weekly hours.

**Step 3:** Add time blocks (leave, court, unavailable windows).

**Step 4:** Booking screens use these rules so slots respect hours and blocks.

## 10. Accounts (cash / payments)

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Accounts is the cash ledger for client/case fees and related payments (IDs like PAY-00001). Accountants typically work here daily.

Payment purposes include: Advance, Stage/partial, Full/final, Consultation, Court fee, Stamp, Copying, Travel, Clerkage, Other. Fee rollup uses fee-type purposes (advance/partial/full/consultation).

**Step 1:** Open Accounts under Office !' filter by client, case, date, or purpose.

**Step 2:** Record a payment: link client (and case if known), amount, purpose, mode/notes !' Save.

**Step 3:** To reverse a wrong entry, use Void (keeps the audit trail).

**Step 4:** Case detail may show fee rollup filtered for that case.

**Step 5:** CSV import uses payments.sample.csv (needs accounts.upload).

## 11. HRMS (attendance & leave)

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**Step 1:** Open HRMS !' Check in at start of work; check out at end (own attendance).

**Step 2:** Submit leave with dates and reason (own leave).

**Step 3:** Managers approve/reject leave (approve leave) and may manage team attendance.

**Step 4:** Maintain office holidays under Holidays when permitted.

## 12. Postal register (DAK)

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Postal / DAK tracks inward and outward office dak — letters, parcels, courier (IDs like DAK-00001).

**Step 1:** Open Postal under Office.

**Step 2:** Create an entry: in/out, reference, parties, date, remarks.

**Step 3:** Edit when status or details change.

**Step 4:** Import historical dak via CSV if migrating (Section 15).

## 13. Work allotment (tasks)

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Office tasks assign work to staff/advocates, often linked to a case (IDs like TSK-00001).

**Step 1:** Open Work allotment under Office.

**Step 2:** Create a task: title, assignee, due date, linked case (optional).

**Step 3:** Update status as work progresses (assignees may get notifications).

**Step 4:** Due items also appear on Day board for the selected day.

## 14. Reports & Excel exports

Open Reports (needs reports.view). Each export also needs view permission on that domain.

| Export              | Also needs                        |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Cases register      | cases.view                        |
| Clients register    | clients.view                      |
| Employees register  | employees.view                    |
| Tasks               | tasks.view                        |
| Postal / Dak        | dak.view                          |
| Accounts / payments | accounts.view                     |
| Appointments        | appointments.view                 |
| Fees outstanding    | accounts.view (+ related)         |
| Attendance          | hrms / attendance rights as shown |

- Some list pages (e.g. Cases) also offer filtered Export on that page.
- Day board / diary may offer printable day views where enabled.

## 15. CSV bulk import

Most list screens offer Import. Always dry-run first, then confirm. Sample CSVs download from the Import dialog. Max about 500 rows per import.

**Step 1:** Open the module !' Import.

**Step 2:** Download the sample CSV for that module.

**Step 3:** Fill rows; save as UTF-8 CSV with the header row.

**Step 4:** Upload !' Dry run. Fix any row errors shown.

**Step 5:** Confirm import (writes data + audit).

| Order | Module   | Sample / permission                                |
|-------|----------|----------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | Clients  | clients.sample.csv · clients.create (+edit upsert) |
| 2     | Cases    | cases.sample.csv · cases.upload (+edit upsert)     |
| 3+    | Hearings | hearings.sample.csv · cases.edit                   |
| 3+    | Payments | payments.sample.csv · accounts.upload              |

|     |                            |                                         |
|-----|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| 3+  | Dak / Tasks / Appointments | matching *.sample.csv · create perms    |
| Any | Employees                  | employees.sample.csv · employees.create |

- Dates: YYYY-MM-DD (IST). Appointment scheduledAt may be full ISO datetime.
- Mobile: 10 digits (system normalizes to 91...).
- Link related rows with \*UnitId columns only (CLI-..., CSE-..., etc.).
- Empty unitId on clients/cases/employees !' auto-generated.
- Unknown extra columns are ignored (shown in dry-run).

## 16. Employees & user accounts

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**Step 1:** Admin/Sub-admin opens Employees.

**Step 2:** Create employee: name, mobile, role(s), designation (IDs like EMP-00001).

**Step 3:** The person signs in with that mobile and sets/uses a PIN (OTP on first login).

**Step 4:** Edit details; upload photo if supported.

**Step 5:** Deactivate when someone leaves; reactivate if they return.

**Step 6:** Force reset PIN when a user is locked out and cannot use OTP themselves.

- Only Admin can assign the Admin role. Sub-admin manages other employees within policy.

## 17. Permissions administration

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**Step 1:** Admin opens Permissions.

**Step 2:** Review the matrix: each role × each module.action.

**Step 3:** Turn allowed on/off for Sub-admin, Staff, Advocate, Accountant as policy requires.

**Step 4:** Save. Users get the union of permissions from all their roles.

- Admin remains full access by design.

## 18. Notifications & profile

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**Step 1:** Click the bell in the header for recent alerts; open the full Notifications page if needed.

**Step 2:** Mark items read as you handle them.

**Step 3:** Open user menu !' Profile to update display details / photo.

**Step 4:** From Profile you may download the office address & mail PDF (signed-in).

**Step 5:** Logout from the same menu when finished.

## 19. Activity (audit log)

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**Step 1:** Open Activity under Admin (activity.view).

**Step 2:** Filter/search creates, updates, voids, imports, and other audited actions.

**Step 3:** Use this for accountability and “who changed what”.

## 20. End-to-end office workflows

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### 20.1 New client !' case !' hearing !' fee

**Step 1:** Create Client (or find existing).

**Step 2:** Create Case linked to that client; set status (often Enquiry or Engaged).

**Step 3:** Assign advocates; move status through pre-filing / filing / active.

**Step 4:** Add Hearings; watch Day board for the hearing day.



**Step 5:** Upload Documents on the case.

**Step 6:** Record fee Payments in Accounts against client/case.

**Step 7:** When finished, move status to Disposed / Withdrawn / Archived as appropriate.

## 20.2 Consultation !' appointment !' case

**Step 1:** Set advocate Availability.

**Step 2:** Book Appointment.

**Step 3:** After meeting, Convert appointment to enquiry Case if engaged.

**Step 4:** Continue on the Cases workflow above.

## 20.3 Daily office rhythm

**Step 1:** Login !' check Home + Notifications.

**Step 2:** Open Day board for today.

**Step 3:** HRMS check-in.

**Step 4:** Work Cases / Clients / Accounts / Dak / Tasks as assigned.

**Step 5:** Export Reports if needed.

**Step 6:** HRMS check-out !' Logout.

## 20.4 Onboarding a new staff member

**Step 1:** Admin creates Employee with correct role.

**Step 2:** Adjust Permissions if the default role matrix is not enough.

**Step 3:** Staff opens site !' OTP !' set PIN !' starts work.

# 21. Quick reference checklist

| I need to...                 | Go to                            |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Register a party             | Clients                          |
| Open / move a matter         | Cases                            |
| See today's court & meetings | Day board                        |
| Book a consultation          | Appointments                     |
| Set advocate free slots      | Availability                     |
| Record a fee / cash entry    | Accounts                         |
| Check in / apply leave       | HRMS                             |
| Log inward/outward post      | Postal                           |
| Assign office work           | Work allotment                   |
| Download Excel               | Reports                          |
| Bulk upload CSV              | Module !' Import (dry-run first) |
| Add a staff login            | Employees                        |

|                        |                              |
|------------------------|------------------------------|
| Change who can do what | Permissions                  |
| See who changed data   | Activity                     |
| Upload case papers     | Case detail !' Documents     |
| Office address PDF     | Profile !' office files link |

- Unit IDs: EMP employees · CLI clients · CSE cases · HRG hearings · APT appointments · PAY payments · DOC documents · DAK postal · TSK tasks · LVE leave · ATT attendance · NTF notifications · HOL holidays.
- Always use these unit IDs in CSV imports and when speaking with support.

### End of guide

If a button or menu is missing, ask Admin to grant the matching permission or confirm the module is enabled.



















